



**THE
KEYS
COACH**

FREE LESSON BOOK

SILENT NIGHT

HOW TO CREATE YOUR OWN ARRANGEMENT

THEKEYSCOACH.COM



This lesson book goes alongside the full-length tutorial video on The Keys Coach YouTube channel.



Adam Saunders
Founder
The Keys Coach

Hi! 🙌

I'm Adam, and I'm here to help you be more confident, creative, and free at the piano.

Silent Night is one of my all-time favorite Christmas carols—it's timeless, beautiful, and perfect for a soulful, gospel-inspired arrangement.

In this special two-part tutorial, I'll guide you step-by-step through the process of transforming Silent Night into a rich and dynamic piano arrangement.

You'll learn how to combine the melody and chords seamlessly to create a full, expressive arrangement.

We'll start by building the harmonic framework, then layer in the melody, and finally blend them together. Once the foundation is set, we'll explore rhythm, embellishments, and other creative techniques to elevate the arrangement to the next level.

I got completely carried away while putting this video together—but hey, it's Christmas!

This is Part 1, and Part 2 will be released next week—depending on when you're reading this!



Backing Track

You can download the Backing Track used in the final playthrough for free.

There is no piano on the track — just the band.

 [Click Here To Download](#)

Let's Dive In!

Underlying Chords

Watch at 2:22, 10:57, & 16:10



"I always start by singing the song and experimenting with chords to find ones that complement the melody."

The first step is to figure out the song's harmonic foundation - in other words, the underlying chords.

You can do this by ear or by using a chord chart. This is also a great chance to experiment with tweaking some of the chords and make the arrangement uniquely yours.

Four systems of musical notation showing piano accompaniment for 'Silent Night' in 3/4 time. Each system consists of a grand staff with treble and bass clefs. Chords are indicated by letters above the notes.

System 1: C, Am7

System 2: Dm7, G⁶, C, C⁷

System 3: F, C, G/B, Am⁷

System 4: F, F[#]0, C/G, Am⁷

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Two staves of musical notation for 'Silent Night' showing chord progressions. The first staff shows Dm7, F/G, G#° (with a sharp sign over the G), Am7, and D9. The second staff shows Dm7, F/G, F, C/E, Dm, and C. Each chord is shown with its notes on a grand staff (treble and bass clef).

Pro Tip: Notice how all the voicings in our right hand flow smoothly from one to the next—this is because we're using **inversions**.

Want To Go Deeper On Inversions? ✨

If you want to dive deeper into mastering inversions, there's a detailed 25-PDF lesson book available, guiding you step-by-step through the entire process to help take your playing even further.

Want To Master Chord Inversions?

[Check out this 25 Page Extended PDF Lesson Book 🚀](#)

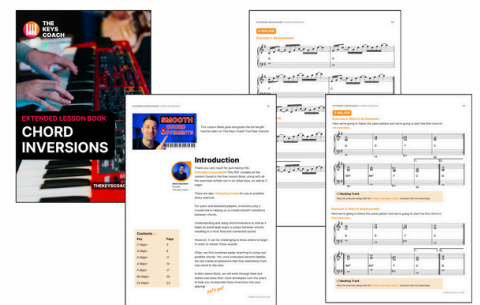


figure out the Melody

Watch at 4:40, 12:26, & 19:17



"Figuring out melodies by ear is one of the best ways to build your creative piano skills. It might take some time at first, but the payoff is huge!"

The next step is to figure out the song's melody.

I usually do this by ear, either singing along as I play or listening to the recording and working it out bit by bit. Start by playing the melody with standard fingerings, then move it to your little finger.

This is because the little finger will be responsible for the melody notes when we put everything together later.

Putting It Together



"This is where the fun really begins!"

Watch at 6:18, 13:04, & 19:48

Full Playthrough: 27:37

Now we're going to combine the melody with the underlying chords. Your little finger will handle the melody while we use the chord-tune-chord approach demonstrated in the video.

What's written here is just a rough guide to what Adam is playing. There might be slight variations in chords, left-hand notes, or other details, but the core of what he's playing is laid out for you.

Once you're comfortable with this, we'll move on to adding rhythm and extra details to really elevate the arrangement.

intro

tune starts here

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The image displays five systems of piano accompaniment for the song 'Silent Night (Xmas Special)'. Each system consists of a grand staff with a treble and bass clef. The notes are written in a simple, accessible style, often using whole and half notes. Chord symbols are placed above the staff to indicate the harmony. The systems are as follows:

- System 1:** Treble clef has a D4 quarter note, a B4 dotted quarter note, and a C5 quarter note. Bass clef has a D2 dotted half note. Chords: Dm7, G7, C, C7.
- System 2:** Treble clef has an A4 quarter note, a G4 dotted quarter note, an F4 quarter note, and a G4 quarter note. Bass clef has an F2 dotted half note. Chords: F, C, G/B, Am7.
- System 3:** Treble clef has an A4 quarter note, a G4 dotted quarter note, an F4 quarter note, and a G4 quarter note. Bass clef has an F2 dotted half note. Chords: F, F#0, C/G, Am7.
- System 4:** Treble clef has a D4 quarter note, a B4 dotted quarter note, a C5 quarter note, and a D5 quarter note. Bass clef has a D2 dotted half note. Chords: Dm7, F/G, G#0, Am7, D9.
- System 5:** Treble clef has a D4 quarter note, a C4 dotted quarter note, a B3 quarter note, and a C4 quarter note. Bass clef has a D2 dotted half note. Chords: Dm11, F/G, F, C/E, Dm7, C.

 Backing Track

Play this along with the backing track, as shown in the video.

 [Click Here To Download](#)

Next Steps...



Adam Saunders
Founder
The Keys Coach

As you can tell, I got a bit carried away with this lesson—so we decided to split it into two parts.

Part 2 will be out next week (depending on when you're reading this). In it, we'll dive into adding dynamic rhythms, extra details, and some bonus tips and tricks to truly take this arrangement to the next level.

If you enjoyed this lesson, feel free to drop the team an email! Let us know where you're tuning in from and what you'd like us to cover in the next YouTube lesson.

We love to hear from people who are finding the lessons useful - adam@thekeyscoach.com



Want To Go Further? 🌟

If you enjoyed this video, be sure to check out this one, where I break down a creative way to use the Circle of Fifths in your piano practice.

➡ Check it out [here](#).

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Will

★★★★★ A structured introduction to music theory which gets you applying it right away
Reviewed in the United Kingdom on 8 October 2024
Verified Purchase



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